

Week 1: The Leash on Chaos

Key Verse: Nahum 1:7 — "The LORD is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; and He knows those who trust in Him."

1. God Is Powerful

God's power isn't just unleashed—it's held back. Every day, God chooses order over chaos. Gravity holds. Sun rises. Oxygen exists. The leash around chaos has a name: God. Every time gravity works instead of floating away—that's God choosing to hold on. Not because He can't let go—because He loves.

Reflection:

Where in your life are you trusting yourself instead of God's power?

What does it mean that God "holds back chaos"?

Application:

What situation will you practice restraint in this week?

2. God Is Patient

"Long of nostrils" (erek appayim) appears 10x in Old Testament. God breathes deeply before responding. This isn't weakness—it's strength under control. Nineveh got 100 years of warnings. Patience isn't weakness—power choosing not to be used because there's still hope.

Reflection:

How does knowing God "calculates before acting" change how you see Him?

Application:

When tempted to explode, what would "long of nostrils" look like in practice?

3. God Is Angry

qanna'—protective jealousy, like a father for his daughter. God's anger is against sin, never people. Like Bryan Mills in Taken—we cheer when he kills because he's protecting his daughter. That's God's wrath: fierce, protective, righteous love. The cross is where wrath and mercy meet—God paid the debt Himself.

Reflection:

What "small sin" have you been tolerating?

Application:

Ask: "Holy Spirit, is there something You've been addressing in me?"

4. God Is Merciful

yada—intimate knowledge, not just seeing. God knows you by name, not number. You don't have to perform—trust is enough. God is a stronghold, a refuge, a place that cannot be shaken. What are you running to for security?

Reflection:

What are you running to for security—job, relationships, reputation?

Application:

Release one area of control to God: "God, I trust You."

Final Reflection:

What does it mean that the cross is where "wrath and mercy meet"?

How does knowing God "knows you" change how you pray?

What would it look like to "stop running" from God this week?
